# Γ-Net: From the First Law of Thermodynamics to Three Inviolable Constraints

**Framework Definition and Theorem Directory**

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We derive the complete axiomatic framework of the Γ-Net theory from a single physical origin: the First Law of Thermodynamics applied to one-dimensional interfaces. Three constraints emerge as *theorems*, not postulates: C1 (energy conservation: $\Gamma^2 + T = 1$), C2 (impedance remodeling: $\Delta Z = -\eta\,\Gamma\,x_{\rm in}\,x_{\rm out}$), and C3 (dimensional relay: $K$-staircase necessity). C2 is proven to be the *unique* first-order activity-gated update rule that minimises reflected energy. We provide a complete inventory of derived quantities and a theorem directory mapping the deductive chain across five companion papers: Paper 1 (existence and irreducibility), Paper 2 (geometric quantification and metabolic scaling), Paper 3 (temporal unification and remodeling equivalence), Paper 4 (topological pathology), Paper 5 (full-system verification). This paper contains no new results beyond the derivation itself; it serves as the master reference for the series.

## I. INTRODUCTION

The Γ-Net framework describes biological organisation as impedance physics. Every interface between two biological media—synapse, blood vessel wall, bone–cartilage junction, cell membrane, skin surface—is characterised by an impedance mismatch that determines how much energy is transmitted versus reflected.

The framework rests on three constraints, C1–C3, which are not modelling choices but consequences of the First Law of Thermodynamics. This paper derives all three from first principles and proves the uniqueness of the central remodeling law (C2).

Five companion papers develop the consequences:

- **Paper 1** [1]: Proves that any finite network *must* have irreducible topological cost ($A_{\rm cut} > 0$), derives the brain as the unique convergence structure, and extends to memory, consciousness, and nociception as impedance dynamics.
- **Paper 2** [2]: Quantifies the geometric cost: derives Murray's law, Kleiber's 3/4-power metabolic scaling, dual-network organ health, and the interface scale table spanning 14 orders of magnitude.
- **Paper 3** [3]: Proves C2 is algebraically equivalent to all 29 known tissue-remodeling laws, derives impedance debt, sleep, the lifecycle equation, aging, and emotion as temporal consequences of a single remodeling rule.
- **Paper 4** [4]: Derives disease as topological perturbation: E0 emergence of cardiovascular, neural, metabolic, and coupled multi-organ pathology from C1/C2/C3 alone, with zero disease-specific code.
- **Paper 5** [5]: Validates the full framework against NHANES epidemiological data ($n$ = 52,545, zero fitted parameters), reports all-cause mortality AUC = 0.705, and collects all falsifiable predictions from Papers 1–4.

A reader entering at any single paper encounters local axiom recaps but lacks: (i) the derivation chain from the First Law to C1/C2/C3; (ii) the proof of C2 uniqueness; (iii) a unified quantity inventory; (iv) a theorem directory mapping every major result to its location in the series. This paper fills those four gaps.

## II. Γ AS THERMODYNAMIC NECESSITY

### A. Impedance at a one-dimensional interface

Consider any one-dimensional interface separating two media with generalised impedances $Z_1$ and $Z_2$, where impedance is defined as the ratio of effort (voltage, pressure, force, temperature) to flow (current, volume flow, velocity, heat flux):

$$Z_k = \frac{\text{effort}_k}{\text{flow}_k}\,. \tag{1}$$

**Theorem 1** (Γ universality (E0))**.** *At any one-dimensional interface between media of impedance $Z_1$ and $Z_2$, the First Law of Thermodynamics requires that incident power be partitioned into reflected and transmitted fractions:*

$$\Gamma = \frac{Z_2 - Z_1}{Z_2 + Z_1}\,, \qquad T = 1 - \Gamma^2 = \frac{4Z_1Z_2}{(Z_1+Z_2)^2}\,, \tag{2}$$

*where $\Gamma$ is the reflection coefficient and $T$ the transmission coefficient.*

*Proof.* At a lossless one-dimensional interface, conservation of energy (First Law) requires: $P_{\rm incident} = P_{\rm reflected} +$

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$P_{\text{transmitted}}$. The boundary conditions on effort and flow (continuity of effort, conservation of flow) uniquely determine the reflected fraction as $|\Gamma|^2 = |(Z_2 - Z_1)/(Z_2 + Z_1)|^2$. This derivation applies identically to electrical transmission lines, acoustic waveguides, hydraulic conduits, mechanical interfaces, and thermal boundaries—the mathematical structure depends only on the existence of effort and flow variables, not on the physical medium. □

**Remark 1** (Why biology is one-dimensional (E0))**.** *A natural question is whether a one-dimensional interface equation can describe a three-dimensional organism. The answer is that biological energy transport is intrinsically one-dimensional: every major structural element in the body is a* fibre*—a 1D waveguide that confines energy flow along a single axis, preventing* $1/r^2$ *spherical dissipation:*

- Axons*: electromagnetic waveguides (myelinated for insulation);*
- Blood vessels*: hydraulic waveguides (collagen/elastin walls confine flow);*
- Tendons/ligaments*: mechanical waveguides (collagen fibres transmit tensile force);*
- Bone trabeculae*: structural waveguides (aligned along compressive stress lines).*

*The three-dimensional body is not a homogeneous solid; it is a network of one-dimensional fibres woven into a 3D topology. Eq. (2) is therefore not a simplification—it describes the actual geometry of biological energy transport.*

Theorem 1 is not a modelling choice. Any system with two impedances meeting at an interface *must* obey this partition. The reflection coefficient $\Gamma$ is as fundamental as temperature or pressure: it exists wherever two impedances meet.

### B. The Minimum Reflection Principle

For an organism with $N$ interface channels, the total reflected (wasted) power is:

$$P_{\text{waste}} = \sum_{i=1}^{N} \Gamma_i^2 \, P_{\text{in},i} \, . \tag{3}$$

An organism is *thermodynamically viable* if and only if

$$P_{\text{metabolic}} > P_{\text{waste}} \, , \tag{4}$$

i.e., its metabolic power production exceeds its reflection losses. Organisms that violate Eq. (4) die by energy deficit—no natural-selection argument is required.

The Minimum Reflection Principle (MRP) is therefore not an optimality *assumption* but a thermodynamic *viability condition*: organisms that waste too much energy at their interfaces fail by physics alone.

Define the **reflection action** over lifetime $T$:

$$\boxed{\mathcal{A}[\Gamma] = \int_0^T \sum_i \Gamma_i^2(t) \, P_{\text{in},i}(t) \, dt \;\rightarrow\; \min \, .} \tag{5}$$

This is the variational principle from which all three constraints are derived.

## III. THE THREE CONSTRAINTS

### A. C1: Energy Conservation

**Theorem 2** (C1 (E0))**.** *At every interface $i$, at every instant $t$:*

$$\Gamma_i^2(t) + T_i(t) = 1 \, , \tag{6}$$

*where $T_i = 1 - \Gamma_i^2$ is the transmission coefficient.*

*Proof.* By Theorem 1, at any lossless one-dimensional interface the reflected power fraction is $|\Gamma_i|^2$ and the transmitted fraction is $T_i = 4Z_1Z_2/(Z_1 + Z_2)^2$. Direct substitution of $\Gamma_i = (Z_2 - Z_1)/(Z_2 + Z_1)$ yields:

$$\Gamma_i^2 + T_i = \frac{(Z_2 - Z_1)^2}{(Z_2 + Z_1)^2} + \frac{4Z_1Z_2}{(Z_2 + Z_1)^2} = \frac{(Z_2 - Z_1)^2 + 4Z_1Z_2}{(Z_2 + Z_1)^2} = \frac{(Z_2 + Z}{(Z_2 + Z} \tag{7}$$

Dissipative corrections modify $Z_i(t)$ over time (Johnson–Nyquist noise, Arrhenius aging) but at each instant the power balance at the interface is governed by the instantaneous impedances, so C1 holds pointwise in time. □

C1 is the First Law applied locally. It holds exactly for any lossless interface. Dissipative corrections (Johnson–Nyquist noise, Arrhenius aging) modify $Z$ over time but never violate power balance at a single interface.

**Remark 2** (Signal power vs. metabolic work (E0))**.** *C1 governs instantaneous* signal power *at each interface: incident = reflected + transmitted. The metabolic energy fuelling C2 remodeling enters as a separate thermodynamic work term that modifies $Z$ itself, not the $\Gamma^2 + T = 1$ identity. The analogy is an electronic amplifier: the DC power supply changes the gain (modifies $Z$), yet Kirchhoff's power law holds at every RF port.*

**Corollary 1** (Thermal Dissipation (E0))**.** *The reflected fraction $\Gamma_i^2$ of incident power is re-absorbed by the source impedance and dissipated as Joule heat:*

$$P_{\text{heat}} = \sum_{i=1}^{N} \Gamma_i^2 \, P_{\text{in},i} \, . \tag{8}$$

*The body temperature in thermal steady state satisfies $P_{\text{heat}} = hA\,(T_{\text{body}} - T_{\text{env}})$. The impedance mismatches that perform computation therefore* generate the heat that sustains the temperature at which those computations remain viable.

### B. C2: Impedance Remodeling

**Theorem 3** (C2 as gradient descent on $\mathcal{A}$ (E0))**.** *First-order gradient descent on the reflection action $\mathcal{A}$ (Eq. 5) with respect to $Z_i$, gated by input and output activity, yields:*

$$\boxed{\Delta Z_i = -\eta\,\Gamma_i\,x_{in,i}\,x_{out,i}\,,} \tag{9}$$

*where $\eta > 0$ is the remodeling rate, $x_{in,i}$ is the input signal, and $x_{out,i}$ is the transmitted signal.*

*Proof.* The functional derivative of $\mathcal{A}$ with respect to $Z_2$ at an interface gives:

$$\frac{\delta\mathcal{A}}{\delta Z_2} = \frac{4Z_1(Z_2 - Z_1)}{(Z_2 + Z_1)^3}\,P_{\text{in}} \propto \Gamma\,. \tag{10}$$

Gradient descent $\Delta Z = -\eta\,(\delta\mathcal{A}/\delta Z)$ with activity gating (update only when both input and output are active) yields Eq. (9). □

C2 is *not a postulate*: it is the unique first-order activity-gated update rule that minimises reflected energy (Section IV). Its form is identical to Hebb's learning rule when $Z$ is synaptic conductance, to Wolff's law when $Z$ is bone stiffness, to Glagov's remodeling when $Z$ is vascular compliance, and to 26 further tissue-specific laws (Paper 3 [3]).

**Historical note.** In the original formulation, C2 was called the "Hebbian update" with signals $x_{\text{pre}}$, $x_{\text{post}}$. Paper 3 proves that the same equation governs all 29 tissue types, making neural-specific terminology misleading. We adopt *impedance remodeling* and $(x_{\text{in}}, x_{\text{out}})$ throughout.

### C. C3: Dimensional Relay

**Theorem 4** (C3 (E0))**.** *When two nodes $i, j$ have different modal complexity $K_i \neq K_j$, direct transmission incurs an irreducible dimensional cost $A_{cut}(i \to j) = (K_i - K_j)^+$ modes of total reflection. The* only *physical mechanism to convert this total reflection into partial transmission is the insertion of relay nodes that form a monotone $K$-staircase between source and target.*

*Proof.* By C1, energy at each mode must satisfy $\Gamma_k^2 + T_k = 1$. If the target has fewer degrees of freedom ($K_j < K_i$), the $(K_i - K_j)$ excess modes have no receiving channel: $T_k = 0$, $\Gamma_k = 1$ for each excess mode. This reflection is *topological*, not impedance-based: C2 cannot remove it because there is no $Z$-mismatch to minimise—the receiving dimension simply does not exist.

The only resolution is to insert intermediate node $m$ with $K_j < K_m < K_i$, splitting the single $(K_i - K_j)$-mode total reflection into two smaller reflections, each of which C2 can partially reduce. By induction, a chain of relays $K_i > K_{m_1} > K_{m_2} > \cdots > K_j$ minimises total $\Gamma^2$ subject to the topological constraint. □ □

C3 explains why biological systems develop layered architecture:

- *Neural*: cortex ($K = 5$) → thalamus → brainstem → spinal cord → motor neuron → muscle ($K = 1$).
- *Vascular*: aorta → arteries → arterioles → capillaries—a fractal $K$-staircase for impedance matching.
- *Skeletal*: bone → cartilage → tendon → muscle—graded stiffness across the joint interface.

Without dimensional relay, high-$K$ controllers and low-$K$ effectors would be separated by 100% reflection walls, and complex life would be physically impossible.

**Remark 3** (Impedance metadata as natural consequence (E0))**.** *The reflected signal at each interface naturally encodes the local impedance pair $(Z_{source}, Z_{load})$ in its amplitude and frequency spectrum. This is not an additional axiom but a direct consequence of C1: since $\Gamma_i = (Z_{load} - Z_{source})/(Z_{load} + Z_{source})$, the reflection coefficient is computable from local data alone. C2 exploits this implicit metadata to perform local gradient descent without global network knowledge.*

**Implementation note.** In the reference implementation (ALICE), the old "C3 metadata tagging" is enforced by requiring all inter-module values to be `ElectricalSignal` objects carrying $Z$ metadata. Raw floating-point numbers between modules are forbidden.

## IV. MATHEMATICAL UNIQUENESS OF C2

**Theorem 5** (C2 uniqueness (E0))**.** *Among all first-order, local, activity-gated update rules of the form $\Delta Z = f(Z, x_{in}, x_{out})$, the rule $\Delta Z = -\eta\,\Gamma\,x_{in}\,x_{out}$ is the* unique *descent direction that minimises $\mathcal{A}[\Gamma]$ at every step.*

*Proof.* Any first-order descent must follow $\Delta Z \propto -\delta\mathcal{A}/\delta Z$. By Eq. (10), $\delta\mathcal{A}/\delta Z \propto \Gamma$. Activity gating restricts updates to epochs where both $x_{\text{in}} \neq 0$ and $x_{\text{out}} \neq 0$. The unique factorisation satisfying locality, activity gating, and descent is $\Delta Z = -\eta\,\Gamma\,x_{\text{in}}\,x_{\text{out}}$ with $\eta > 0$. □

### A. The tissue is not the algorithm

The molecular machineries implementing C2 differ vastly across tissues: NMDA receptors (neural), RANKL/OPG (bone), eNOS (vascular), AID somatic hypermutation (immune), keratinocyte $Ca^{2+}$ (skin), HGF (liver), EPO (marrow), FSH receptors (reproductive)—completely different molecular pathways implementing the same equation. The substrate determines the material constants ($\eta$, $Z_0$); the equation is dictated by physics.

### B. Objective function for viability

The Γ-framework supplies a *physical* objective function: $\mathcal{A} = \int_0^T \sum_i \Gamma_i^2 \, P_{\mathrm{in},i} \, dt$. Any system whose $\mathcal{A}$ exceeds the viability bound is physically excluded. This is a constraint on what *can* exist, not an explanation of what *does* exist.

### C. Sex as a boundary condition

Sex does not alter C1–C3. The hypothalamic–pituitary–gonadal (HPG) axis sets sex-specific $Z_{\mathrm{setpoint}}$ values: testosterone raises $\eta_{\mathrm{muscle}}$; oestrogen modulates $Z_{\mathrm{adipose}}$ and $Z_{\mathrm{bone}}$ (menopause $\equiv$ $Z_{\mathrm{bone}} \uparrow$, $\Gamma_{\mathrm{bone}} \uparrow$); pre-menopausal oestrogen maintains lower $\Gamma_{\mathrm{vasc}}$ via enhanced endothelial C2. Sex is a parametric shift in boundary conditions, not a different dynamical law.

## V. DERIVED QUANTITIES

Table I lists every named quantity in the Γ-Net framework, ordered by the paper where it first appears.

## VI. THEOREM DIRECTORY

The five companion papers form a deductive chain radiating outward from C1/C2/C3. Each paper occupies a unique mathematical role. Table II provides the complete map.

### A. The deductive chain

The logical structure is a concentric expansion:

| Layer | Content | |
|---|---|---|
| 0 | First Law → Γ, C1, MRP, C2, C3 | (this paper) |
| 1 | C2 on finite network → $A_{\mathrm{cut}} > 0$ → topology, brain, mind | (Paper 1) |
| 2 | C2 on branching geometry → Murray, Kleiber, $H$ | (Paper 2) |
| 3 | C2 ≡ 29 laws → $D_Z$, sleep, lifecycle, aging | (Paper 3) |
| 4 | Topology + perturbation → disease emergence (E0) | (Paper 4) |
| 5 | Γ-vector + NHANES → validation, blueprints, predictions | (Paper 5) |

Each layer uses only C1/C2/C3 plus the results of inner layers. No layer imports concepts from an outer layer. This unidirectional dependency is the structural guarantee against circularity.

## VII. WHAT THIS THEORY DOES NOT CLAIM

The Γ-framework derives *physical constraints* that any living system must satisfy. It does *not* reconstruct evolutionary history.

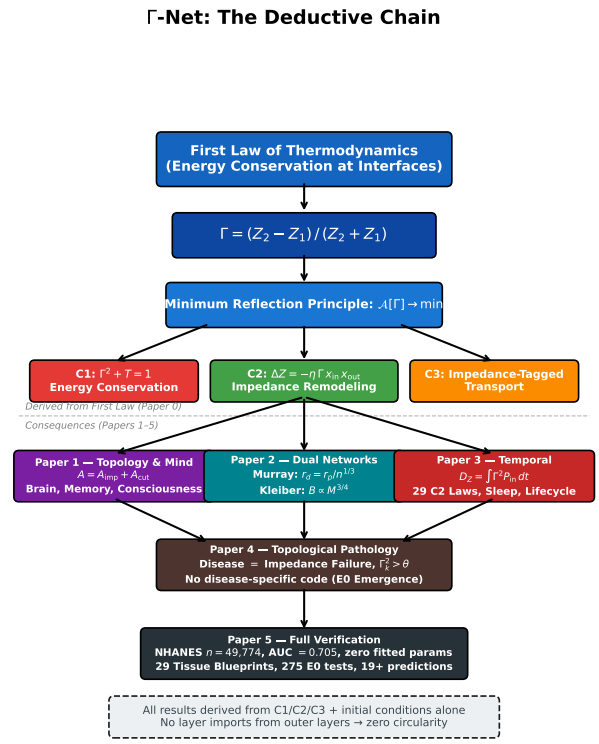


FIG. 1. The deductive chain of the Γ-Net framework. From the First Law of Thermodynamics, Γ emerges as thermodynamic necessity; the Minimum Reflection Principle yields C1/C2/C3; each subsequent paper applies these constraints to a specific domain. No layer imports from an outer layer.

1. **Necessary conditions, not sufficient causes.** The framework shows that a $K$=5 brain *must* maintain $T > T_c(5)$ and *must* have vasculature. It does not explain *why* such brains appeared or *which* lineages developed them.

2. **No evolutionary trajectory.** Statements such as "the tidal zone offers the lowest-action path" identify geometric optima in impedance space. Whether any lineage actually traversed that path is a question for palaeontology, not for this framework.

3. **C2 uniqueness is mathematical, not biological.** The proof that C2 is the unique first-order $\mathcal{A}$-minimising rule is a theorem about gradient descent. That multiple molecular machineries converge on the same equation is *consistent with* C2 being a physical attractor; it is not evidence that evolution "discovered" C2.

TABLE I. Complete quantity inventory of the Γ-Net framework.

| Symbol | Name | Definition | Interpretation | Paper |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $\Gamma_i$ | Reflection coefficient | $\frac{Z_{\text{load},i}-Z_{\text{source},i}}{Z_{\text{load},i}+Z_{\text{source},i}}$ | Mismatch at interface $i$ | 0 |
| $T_i$ | Transmission coefficient | $1-\Gamma_i^2$ | Fraction of power delivered | 0 |
| $\mathcal{A}$ | Reflection action | $\int_0^T \sum_i \Gamma_i^2 P_{\text{in},i}\, dt$ | Total wasted energy | 0 |
| $A_{\text{imp}}$ | Improvable action | $\mathcal{A} - A_{\text{cut}}$ | Reducible by C2 remodeling | 1 |
| $A_{\text{cut}}$ | Irreducible action | $\sum_{k>K^*} \Gamma_k^2$ | Topological cost immune to C2 | 1 |
| $\Phi_{\text{meta}}$ | Consciousness index | $1-\Gamma_{\text{meta}}^2$ | Self-referential matching | 1 |
| $\mathcal{S}$ | Null space ("soul") | $\ker(\partial Z/\partial t)$ | Impedances immune to experience | 1 |
| $\beta$ | Murray bifurcation ratio | $2^{1/3} \approx 1.26$ | Optimal branch radius ratio | 2 |
| $\Omega$ | Dual-network overhead | $\geq 1$ | Packing cost of two trees | 2 |
| $H$ | Health index | $\prod_i (1-\Gamma_i^2)$ | Whole-body transmission | 2 |
| $D_Z$ | Impedance debt | $\int_0^{T_{\text{wake}}} \lvert\Gamma\rvert^2 P_{\text{in}}\, dt$ | Cumulative mismatch; cleared by sleep | 3 |
| Lifecycle | Lifecycle ODE | $\frac{d(\Sigma\Gamma^2)}{dt} = -\eta\,\Sigma\Gamma^2 + \gamma\,\Gamma_{\text{env}} + \delta\, D(t)$ | Cognition bathtub curve | 3 |
| $\Pi_\Gamma$ | Gamma-Pain Index | $w_n\Gamma_n^2 + w_v\Gamma_v^2 + w_D \frac{dD_Z}{dt}$ | Consciousness-independent pain | 4 |

4. **Compatibility, not replacement.** Natural selection determines which lineages survive; the Γ-framework supplies the physical objective function that selection operates on.

Throughout the six papers, any sentence referencing evolution should be read as *physical constraint language*: "$X$ is required" means "any system with property $Y$ must satisfy $X$".

## VIII. NOTATION CONVENTIONS

Table III collects notation used across Papers 0–5.

**Corollary 2** (Universal relay-node necessity (E0))**.** *Paper 1 proves that a heterogeneous network with geometric cost floor $A_{\text{cut}} > 0$ requires relay nodes for signal integrity. The Interface Isomorphism (Paper 2) guarantees that $\Gamma = (Z_2 - Z_1)/(Z_2 + Z_1) \neq 0$ at* every *impedance-discontinuous boundary, regardless of medium. Together, these two results imply that relay structures are a thermodynamic necessity at* every *tissue interface in the body, not only in the nervous system.*

| ***Interface*** | ***Relay structure*** | ***Z discontinuity*** |
|---|---|---|
| *Neuron–neuron* | *Synapse* | *Axonal vs. dendritic $Z_n$* |
| *Blood–tissue* | *Capillary endothelium* | *Fluid vs. interstitial $Z_v$* |
| *Blood–filtrate* | *Glomerulus (kidney)* | *Haemodynamic vs. osmotic Z* |
| *Blood–brain* | *Blood–brain barrier* | *Vascular vs. neural Z* |
| *Immune–tissue* | *Lymph node* | *Lymphatic vs. interstitial Z* |
| *Blood–air* | *Alveolar membrane* | *Fluid vs. gas-phase Z* |
| *Flow direction* | *Heart valve* | *Forward vs. reverse $Z_v$* |

*None of these structures are independent evolutionary inventions; each is the unique topological solution to $\Gamma \neq 0$ at its respective interface.*

***Duality.*** *The same relay topology that maintains signal integrity also provides the propagation path for pathological cascades (Paper 4): a relay node can transmit both matched signals and impedance-mismatch damage across boundaries. Signal maintenance and disease propagation are two faces of the same relay necessity.*

## IX. OPERATIONAL DEFINITION OF MODAL COMPLEXITY $K$

A potential concern is that the modal complexity $K_i$ assigned to each neural structure (e.g. $K = 5$ for cortical pyramidal cells, $K = 1$ for C-fibres) might be treated as a free parameter. We clarify here that $K$ is *in principle measurable* using two independent protocols:

1. **Diffusion Tensor Imaging (DTI).** The number of independent fibre directions crossing a voxel of

TABLE II. Theorem directory: the deductive chain from C1/C2/C3 to all major results. Each row is a theorem or major result, with its paper of origin and the constraints required for its derivation. Theorems are grouped by paper and by mathematical role.

| Paper | Role | Theorem / Result | Requires | Section |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Paper 1: Existence and Irreducibility* | | | | |
| | Existence | $\mathcal{A} = A_{\text{imp}} + A_{\text{cut}}$, $A_{\text{cut}} > 0$ | C1, C2, $K$-dim cascade | P1 §2–3 |
| | Topology | Same-$K$ clustering, relay hierarchy | $A_{\text{cut}} > 0$, C2 | P1 §4–5 |
| | Convergence | Brain as unique convergence structure | Relay hierarchy | P1 §6 |
| | Memory | Memory $\equiv dZ/dt$ (three regimes) | C2 | P1 §8 |
| | Consciousness | $\Phi_{\text{meta}} = 1 - \Gamma^2_{\text{meta}}$; Television Theorem | C1, C2, feedback | P1 §9–10 |
| | Soul | $\mathcal{S} = \ker(\partial Z/\partial t)$; four laws of null space | C2 uniqueness | P1 §11 |
| | Nociception | Three-layer pain; $\Pi_\Gamma$ index | C1, C2, SNR | P1 §13–14 |
| *Paper 2: Geometric Quantification* | | | | |
| | Vascular | Murray's law from $\Gamma$-minimisation; $\beta = 2^{1/3}$ | C2, Poiseuille $Z$ | P2 §2–4 |
| | Scaling | $A_{\text{cut}} \propto M^{2/3}$; Kleiber $B \propto M^{3/4}$ | $A_{\text{cut}}$, Murray, $\Omega$ | P2 §7–8 |
| | Dual-network | $H = (1-\Gamma_n^2)(1-\Gamma_v^2)$; four failure modes | C1, C2, two buses | P2 §5–6 |
| | Universality | Interface scale table (14 orders of magnitude) | $\Gamma$ universality (Thm 1) | P2 §9 |
| *Paper 3: Temporal Unification* | | | | |
| | Equivalence | C2 $\equiv$ 29 tissue-remodeling laws | C2, tissue substitutions | P3 §2 |
| | Sleep | Sleep $= D_Z$ discharge; gate-leak inequality | C2, $D_Z$, Johnson–Nyquist | P3 §3–5 |
| | Lifecycle | $\frac{d(\Sigma\Gamma^2)}{dt} = -\eta\Sigma\Gamma^2 + \gamma\Gamma_{\text{env}} + \delta D$ | C2, $D_Z$, Arrhenius | P3 §6 |
| | Aging | Coffin–Manson fatigue; death as $\Gamma^2_{\text{basal}} \geq 1$ | C2, null space, $D_Z$ | P3 §7 |
| | Emotion | Dopamine = RPE; Yerkes–Dodson; curiosity | C2, $D_Z$ | P3 §8 |
| | Morphogenesis | Dual-field PDE ($\partial Z/\partial t$, $\partial\rho/\partial t$) | C2, reaction–diffusion | P3 §9 |
| *Paper 4: Topological Pathology* | | | | |
| | E0 cardio | HTN, MI, aortic stenosis from topology | C1/C2/C3, GammaTopology | P4 §2 |
| | E0 neural | ALS, stroke, PTSD, phantom limb from topology | C1/C2/C3, GammaTopology | P4 §3 |
| | Coupled | Five-organ cascade; three recovery regimes | C2, coupling matrix | P4 §4–5 |
| | Metabolic | T2DM six-channel hexagonal deadlock | C2, bifurcation | P4 §6 |
| | Necrosis | Tissue necrosis as substrate collapse | $D_Z > D^{\max}_{\text{repair}}$ | P4 §7 |
| | Sleep path. | Insomnia / narcolepsy / hypersomnia | Gate-leak inequality | P4 §8 |
| *Paper 5: Full-System Verification* | | | | |
| | NHANES | 7/7 organs AUC significant; $C = 0.70$; 6.89× risk ratio | $\Gamma$ universality, $H$ | P5 §2 |
| | Propagation | Cross-organ AUC gain (cardiac +0.166) | Network coupling | P5 §3 |
| | Blueprints | 29 tissue blueprints; 278 nodes, 426 edges | C1/C2/C3, $K$-cascade | P5 §4 |
| | Ablation | C2-on/C2-off pincer tests | E0 emergence | P5 §5 |
| | Predictions | 19+ falsifiable predictions (unified list) | Papers 1–4 | P5 §6 |

volume $V$ is estimated by the rank of the diffusion tensor $\mathbf{D}$: $K_{\text{DTI}} = \text{rank}(\mathbf{D})$. For white-matter tracts this yields $K = 1$ (single dominant eigenvector); for cortical grey matter the orientation distribution function (ODF) typically admits $K = 3$–6 independent peaks.

2. **Multi-unit electrophysiology.** Record $N$ simultaneous spike trains at a node; perform principal component analysis (PCA) on the cross-correlation matrix. $K$ is the number of eigenvalues exceeding the Marchenko–Pastur noise threshold:

$$K_{\text{ephys}} = \#\{\lambda_i : \lambda_i > \lambda_{\text{MP}}(N, T)\}\,.$$

This counts the number of independently modulated signal dimensions at that node.

Crucially, the qualitative results of Papers 1–5 (e.g. Directional Asymmetry, Thermal Attractor) depend only on the *ordering* $K_i > K_j$, not on the absolute values. Only quantitative predictions (e.g. the exact number of reflected modes) require calibrated $K$ values. Independent measurement of $K$ via DTI or electrophysiology is a falsifiable experimental programme that can validate or refute the framework.

TABLE III. Notation conventions used across all six papers.

| Symbol | Meaning | Units / Range | Paper |
|---|---|---|---|
| $Z$ | Impedance | $\Omega$ etc. | 0 |
| $\Gamma$ | Reflection coefficient | $[-1, +1]$ | 0 |
| $T$ | Transmission $(1-\Gamma^2)$ | $[0, 1]$ | 0 |
| $\eta$ | Remodeling rate | $> 0$ | 0 |
| $(x_{\text{in}}, x_{\text{out}})$ | Interface signals | signal units | 0 |
| $\mathcal{A}$ | Reflection action | J·s | 0 |
| $K$ | Modal complexity | integer $\geq 1$ | 1 |
| $A_{\text{imp}}$ | Improvable action | J·s | 1 |
| $A_{\text{cut}}$ | Cutoff action | J·s | 1 |
| $\Phi_{\text{meta}}$ | Consciousness index | $[0, 1]$ | 1 |
| $\mathcal{S}$ | Null space | — | 1 |
| $\beta$ | Murray ratio $(2^{1/3})$ | dimensionless | 2 |
| $\Omega$ | Dual-network overhead | $\geq 1$ | 2 |
| $H$ | Health index | $[0, 1]$ | 2 |
| $Z_v, Z_n$ | Vascular / neural $Z$ | domain-specific | 2 |
| $D_Z$ | Impedance debt | J·s | 3 |
| $T_c(K)$ | Critical temperature | °C | 3 |
| $\Pi_\Gamma$ | Γ-Pain Index | dimensionless | 4 |

## X. CONCLUSION

The Γ-Net framework is derived, not postulated. The First Law of Thermodynamics at a one-dimensional interface yields the reflection coefficient Γ. Energy conservation gives C1 ($\Gamma^2 + T = 1$). Gradient descent on the reflection action gives C2 ($\Delta Z = -\eta\,\Gamma\,x_{\text{in}}\,x_{\text{out}}$), proven unique among first-order activity-gated rules. Dimensional relay gives C3.

From these three constraints, five companion papers derive, in a strictly outward deductive chain: topology and the mind (Paper 1), geometric quantification and metabolic scaling (Paper 2), temporal unification across 29 tissues (Paper 3), disease as topological pathology (Paper 4), and full-system verification against epidemiological data (Paper 5).

This paper provides the master reference: a derivation chain (Sections II–IV), a quantity inventory (Table I), and a theorem directory (Table II).

All source code, simulation scripts, and NHANES pipelines are available at `https://github.com/cyhuang76/alice-gamma-net` under AGPL-3.0.


[1] H.-Y. Huang, "The irreducibility theorem and the physics of mind: topology, memory, consciousness, and nociception from impedance constraints," companion Paper 1 (2026).

[2] H.-Y. Huang, "Geometric quantification: Murray's law, Kleiber scaling, and dual-network organ health from Γ-minimisation," companion Paper 2 (2026).

[3] H.-Y. Huang, "Temporal unification: C2 as twenty-nine tissue laws, impedance debt, sleep, and the lifecycle equation," companion Paper 3 (2026).

[4] H.-Y. Huang, "Topological pathology: disease emergence from C1/C2/C3 without disease-specific code," companion Paper 4 (2026).

[5] H.-Y. Huang, "Full-system verification: NHANES validation, tissue blueprints, and falsifiable predictions," companion Paper 5 (2026).

[6] H.-Y. Huang, *ALICE: A physics-driven electronic lifeform*, `https://github.com/cyhuang76/alice-gamma-net` (2026).